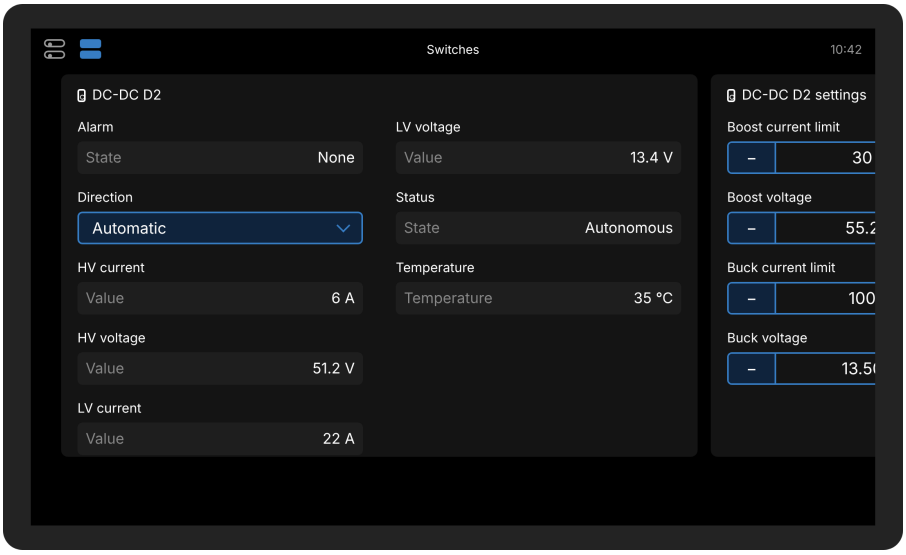
INSTALLATION GUIDE · CONTROL EDITION V1.4

Nomadic D2 DC-DC converter on your Victron Cerbo GX

Make the cable, set up the Cerbo, and install the driver. When you're done, the D2's readings and controls appear on the Cerbo screen, in the VRM app and on a web page.

> **This is the control edition, for advanced users.** It can command the D2. If you only want to see what the D2 is doing, use the monitor-only edition instead (`github.com/CKOCI13/CKOCI13-cerbo-nomadic-d2-monitor`), which never sends the D2 anything.



What you'll see on the Cerbo screen when you're done (drawn from Victron's own screen design, so the real screen may differ slightly).

You'll be able to

- See LV/HV voltage and current, temperature, status and alarms
- Leave the D2 on its own Automatic logic, or take control with Off, Buck (48 V to 12 V) or Boost (12 V to 48 V)
- Change the voltage targets and current limits

Good to know

- It takes about 1 hour, including making the cable
- Nothing changes until you choose. The Cerbo starts in Automatic, so the D2 keeps working exactly as it does today
- You don't need to type any commands. The **Cerbo Setup** helper does it for you

STEP 1 Get what you need

STEP 2 Make the cable

STEP 3 Set up the Cerbo

STEP 4 Connect everything

STEP 5 Install the driver

STEP 6 Use it

1 Get what you need

Gather everything before you start.

For the cable

- A standard Ethernet patch cable (Cat5e or Cat6), long enough to reach from the Cerbo to the D2
- Two crimp contacts to add CAN_H and CAN_L to the D2's 6-pin signal plug (TE Connectivity connector 1-967616-1, per the D2 manual). Ask Nomadic or a TE distributor for the matching plug and contacts, or for a ready-made pigtail
- A ring terminal (M8) or a free spot on your ground bus, for the CAN ground wire
- Wire cutters, a wire stripper and a crimp tool for the TE contacts
- Heat-shrink tubing or electrical tape
- A multimeter with a continuity (beep) setting and an Ohms setting
- A VE.Can terminator: the small RJ45 plug that came in the Cerbo box
- A 120 Ω resistor (¼ W) for the D2 end. The D1 had no built-in terminator and the D2 manual doesn't mention one; step 2g shows how to check

For the software

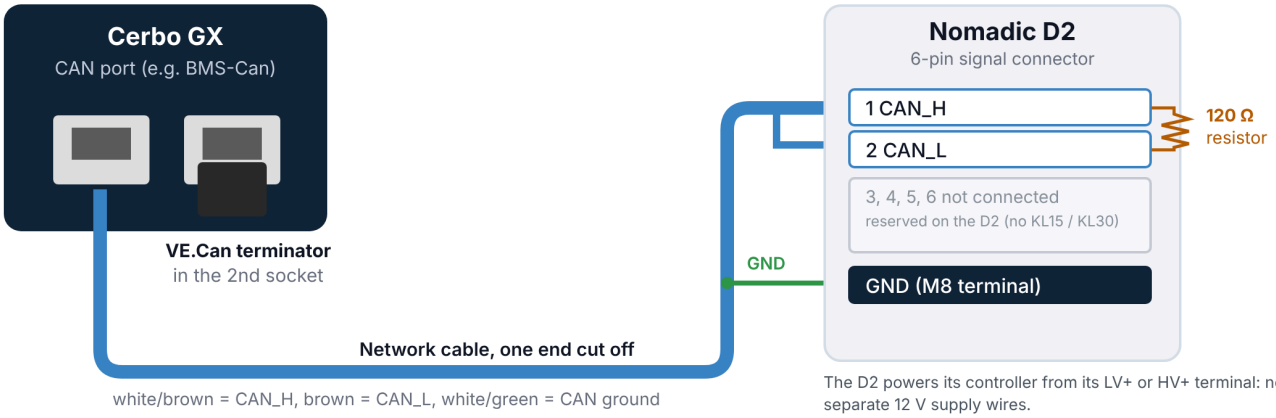
- A Windows PC on the same network (Wi-Fi or Ethernet) as the Cerbo
- The project folder downloaded from GitHub, which contains **Cerbo Setup.bat** and the **dbus-nomadic-dcdc** folder
- The Cerbo running Venus OS **v3.80 or newer**. Step 3 shows you how to check

> **Safety**
>
> Before you work on the D2's wiring, open the fuses or breakers on **both** its LV+ (12 V) and HV+ (48 V) leads and follow the D2 manual. The D2 has no KL30/KL15 supply to switch off: it powers itself from whichever power terminal is live. The CAN cable only carries data, but it ends next to the D2's 48 V and 12 V power terminals.

2 Make the cable

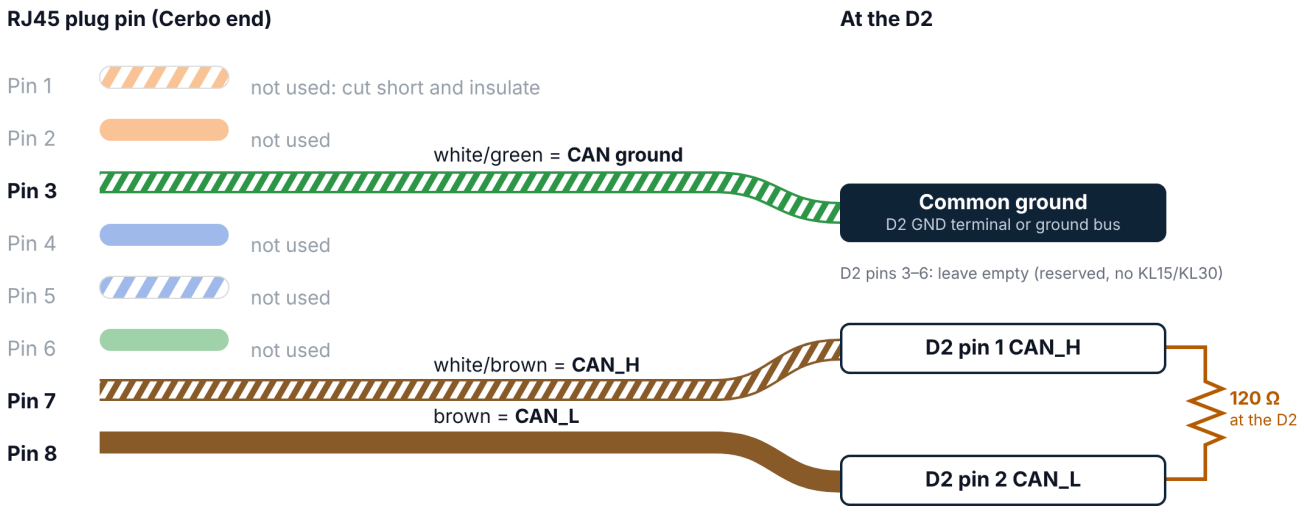
The Cerbo uses **RJ45 sockets**, the same plug as network cables. The easiest way is to take a ready-made network cable, keep the plug on one end for the Cerbo, and cut off the other end. You only need **3 of its 8 wires**: CAN_H and CAN_L go into the D2's signal plug, and the CAN ground goes to the common ground.

The whole connection

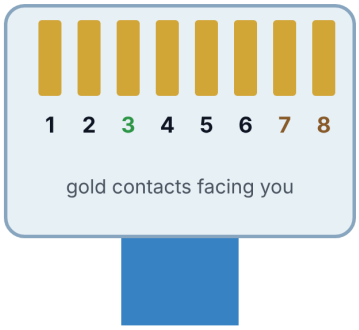


Blue: the network cable you make (CAN), with the required 120 Ω resistor across CAN_H and CAN_L at the D2. Green: CAN ground to the D2's common ground. Pins 3–6 stay empty: unlike the D1, the D2 has no KL30/KL15 supply wires and powers itself from its LV+/HV+ terminals. If you are replacing a D1, take its old KL15/KL30 wires off the plug and insulate them.

Which wire goes where

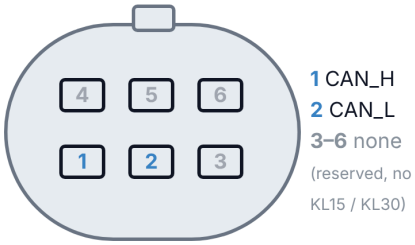


Pins 7 and 8 are the **brown pair** (twisted together), which suits CAN well. Pin 3 is **white/green** on most cables (T568B), or **white/orange** on T568A cables. The multimeter check in step 2b tells you which.



cable pointing down, clip at the back

RJ45 plug (Cerbo end): pin 1 is on the left.



layout as drawn in the D2 manual
(facing the D2's connector)

D2 6-pin signal connector (TE 1-967616-1). Check the numbers moulded on the connector before you crimp.

Wire	RJ45 pin (Cerbo)	Goes to (D2)
white/brown	7	**Pin 1 CAN_H** on the 6-pin signal connector
brown	8	**Pin 2 CAN_L** on the 6-pin signal connector
white/green (white/orange on T568A)	3	**Common ground**: the D2's GND terminal, or the ground bus it's bolted to. The D2's signal connector has no ground pin
The other 5 wires (pins 1, 2, 4, 5, 6)		Not used. Cut them short and insulate each one

Sources: Victron's *VE.Can to CAN-bus BMS cables manual* (Cerbo side: pin 7 CAN-H, pin 8 CAN-L, pin 3 GND) and the *D2 Bidirectional DC-DC Converter Manual*, Rev D (signal connector pinout).

Make it

2a **Cut off one plug.** Keep the other plug for the Cerbo. Strip about 5 cm (2 in) of the grey outer jacket.

2b **Check the wires with a multimeter** on the continuity (beep) setting. Touch one probe to a gold contact on the plug and the other to a wire:

- Pin 7 should beep with **white/brown**
- Pin 8 should beep with **brown**
- Pin 3 should beep with **white/green**. If it beeps with white/orange instead, use white/orange as the CAN ground

2c **Insulate the 5 wires you don't need.** Cut them short and cover **each one** separately with heat-shrink or tape, so none can touch anything.

2d **Add CAN_H and CAN_L to the D2's signal plug.** With the D2 switched off, crimp contacts onto **white/brown** (into **pin 1, CAN_H**) and **brown** (into **pin 2, CAN_L**). Keep the brown pair twisted together as close to the plug as you can. If your D2 is already wired, unplug the existing signal plug and add the two contacts to it.

2e **Connect the CAN ground.** Put a ring terminal on the **white/green** wire and connect it to the **common ground**: the D2's GND terminal, or the ground bus that terminal is bolted to.

> Never connect any of the network-cable wires to the D2's HV+ or LV+ terminals. CAN_H and CAN_L only go to pins 1 and 2 of the signal plug.

2f **Leave signal pins 3 to 6 empty.** Unlike the D1, the D2 has no KL30 or KL15: it powers its own controller from whichever of its LV+ and HV+ terminals has a source on it, and talks on CAN whenever it is powered.

Pin	Connect to
3, 4, 5, 6	Nothing. The D2 manual (Rev D) says "reserved, do not connect". If you are replacing a D1, remove its old KL15 (pin 3) and KL30 (pin 4) wires from the plug and insulate their ends

2g **Fit the 120 Ω resistor at the D2.** First, with everything off and the signal plug out, measure across the D2's own pins 1 and 2: if it reads about 120 Ω it already has a terminator, so skip this step. Otherwise connect a 120 Ω resistor between CAN_H and CAN_L at the D2 end, for example between the white/brown and brown wires where they meet the signal plug. Insulate it with heat-shrink.
Check: with the RJ45 plug not yet in the Cerbo, measure between the white/brown and brown wires (or pins 7 and 8 of the RJ45 plug). It should read about **120 Ω**.

2h **Final check:** plug the RJ45 into the Cerbo port you'll use, with the VE.Can terminator in that port's other socket. With everything switched off, measure between white/brown and brown again:

You measure	Meaning
About 60 Ω	Correct: both ends are terminated
About 120 Ω	The VE.Can terminator isn't in the Cerbo port's other socket, or the cable is in a different port
Very high or "OL"	The resistor at the D2 isn't connected. Re-check step 2g

3 Set up the Cerbo

Do this on the Cerbo's touchscreen, or remotely with Remote Console in VRM. Every item below is found from the Settings menu.

3a **Check the firmware version.** Go to **Settings › General › Firmware**. It needs to be **v3.80 or newer**. If it's older, use **Online updates** on the same page to update first.

3b **Write down the Cerbo's IP address.** Go to **Settings › Connectivity › Ethernet** (or Wi-Fi) and read the IP address.
IP address: _____

3c **Choose the CAN port and speed.** Use the Cerbo's second CAN port, with nothing else plugged into it. The labels next to the ports tell you which Cerbo you have:

- **Cerbo GX MK2** (ports labeled **VE.Can 1** and **VE.Can 2**): go to **Settings › Connectivity › VE.Can port 2** (some firmware still calls it **BMS-Can port**) and set **CAN-bus profile** to **Up, but no services (250 kbit/s)**. The D2 talks at either 250 or 500 kbit/s. Start with 250. Step 5c shows each port's speed, and tells you if the D2 is talking at the other speed. Then change the profile to **Up, but no services (500 kbit/s)**.
- **Original Cerbo GX** (second port labeled **BMS-Can**): go to **Settings › Connectivity › BMS-Can port**. This port only runs at 500 kbit/s and can't be set to "Up, but no services", so leave it on **CAN-bus BMS (500 kbit/s)**. It works only if the D2 talks at 500 kbit/s. If step 5c reports bus errors on it, the D2 is at 250 kbit/s: use the VE.Can port (if nothing else is on it) with **Up, but no services (250 kbit/s)** instead.

3d **Let your PC connect to the Cerbo** (this switches on SSH):

1. Go to **Settings › General › Access & Security › Access level** and choose **User & Installer**. The password is `zzz`.
2. Still on the Access & Security page, drag the list down with your finger and hold it for about 5 seconds (on Remote Console with a keyboard: hold the right-arrow key). The access level changes to **Superuser**.
3. Tap **Root password** and choose a password (at least 8 characters).
   Root password: _____
4. Switch **Enable SSH on LAN** to on.

3e **Optional, to change settings from VRM:** go to **Settings › VRM › VRM Portal access level** and set it to **Full**.

4 Connect everything

4a Plug the cable's RJ45 plug into the CAN port you chose in 3c, with the VE.Can terminator in the port's other socket (as in step 2h).

4b Plug the D2's signal plug back in and close the fuses or breakers on its LV+ and HV+ leads.

Nothing changes for the D2 yet. The Cerbo only listens until you finish Step 5, and even after that it starts in **Automatic** (it sends no commands).

5 Install the driver with Cerbo Setup

5a **Open the helper.** In the project folder, double-click `Cerbo Setup.bat`. If Windows shows "Windows protected your PC", click **More info** and then **Run anyway**.

5b **Type the Cerbo's IP address** from step 3b and press **Enter**. The helper remembers it for next time, and then shows its menu:

```
  ============================================================
    Nomadic DC-DC converter  -  Cerbo GX setup
    Cerbo address: 192.168.1.50
  ============================================================

    1  Edit the settings (config.ini)
    2  Find which Cerbo port the converter is on    (listen only)
    3  Watch live readings from the converter       (listen only)
    4  Install or update the driver on the Cerbo
    5  Show the driver log

    U  Make a USB-stick installer (no network needed)

    9  Try it with a pretend converter (simulation - nothing is sent)

    6  Change the Cerbo address
    7  Fix "REMOTE HOST IDENTIFICATION HAS CHANGED"
    8  Uninstall the driver from the Cerbo
    0  Exit

  Type a number and press Enter: _
```

> **Want to see it first?** Option **9** runs everything with a pretend D2 and sends nothing on CAN (see the Safe Test Plan, `docs/safe-test-plan.pdf`).

> **The password prompt.** Every option that talks to the Cerbo asks for the root password from step 3d. **Nothing appears on screen while you type it.** That's normal: type it and press Enter.

5c **Type `2` : find the converter.** The helper copies the driver to the Cerbo and listens on every CAN port for 3 seconds. You should see something like this:

```
Venus OS v3.80 OK
Listening 3 s on each CAN port (nothing is transmitted)...
  can0    250 kbit/s  error-active  nothing from the converter
  can1    250 kbit/s  error-active  CONVERTER FOUND (391 frames)
The converter is on can1, which matches config.ini. Good.
```

If it says "In config.ini set: interface = can0", make that change in the next step. If the D2 is set to the other speed, you'll see bus errors instead:

```
  can1    250 kbit/s  error-passive nothing decoded, but 288 bus errors: talking at a different
speed?
Something is talking on can1 at a different speed. On the Cerbo, set that port's CAN-bus
profile to "Up, but no services (500 kbit/s)" and run this again.
```

Do what it says (step 3c), then type `2` again. If nothing is heard at all, see Troubleshooting, and check first that the D2 has power on its LV+ or HV+ terminal.

5d **Type `1` : edit the settings.** Notepad opens `config.ini`. Check these lines, then press Ctrl+S to save and close Notepad:

Line	What to put
`interface = can1`	The port that step 5c found
`startup = auto`	Leave as auto: after every Cerbo restart the D2 runs on its own logic
`boost_voltage = 55.2`	The 48 V target used when you choose Boost. Set it to your 48 V battery's charge voltage
`buck_voltage = 13.5`	The 12 V target used when you choose Buck. 13.5 V charges the chassis batteries properly (it's also the D2's maximum)
`buck_current_limit`, `boost_current_limit`	The output current used for Buck (D2 max 178 A) and Boost (D2 max 57 A). Keep them within your wiring and fuses
`..._min` / `..._max` lines	Safety limits. They're preset to the D2 manual's ranges; tighten them if your batteries, cables or fuses need it
`custom_name = DC-DC D2`	The name shown on the Cerbo and in VRM
`password =`	Optional: a password for the web page

Nobody can set a value outside the limits, whether from the Cerbo screen, VRM or the web page.

5e **Type `3` : watch the live readings** (optional, but a good check). The voltages should match what a meter shows on the D2's terminals. To stop, press Ctrl+C, then type N and press Enter.

```
--- can1 10:42:07  ONLINE  0x066=20/s 0x088=100/s 0x520=10/s
LV  13.4 V  +22 A | HV  51.2 V   +6 A | 35 C
Mode: Autonomous (default set-point) | Precharge not in process
Alarms: none
Software 1.2.3  Hardware 5
```

5f **Type `4` : install.** After about 10 seconds you should see:

```
/service/dbus-nomadic-dcdc: up (pid 1834) 6 seconds
... INFO: Nomadic DC-DC driver 1.4.0 starting on can1
... INFO: Converter online on can1
```

Done! It now starts by itself after every reboot and firmware update, in Automatic, so the D2 keeps working exactly as before.

No network to the Cerbo? Install from a USB stick instead

Venus OS can install add-ons from a USB stick or microSD card by itself, with no SSH or password. Do this instead of 5c–5f:

U1 In Cerbo Setup, type `1` and set `interface` (and anything else) in config.ini. The stick's settings replace the ones on the Cerbo. When Cerbo Setup asks for the IP address, you can just press Enter.

U2 Type `U`. It makes `venus-data.tar.gz` in the project folder. Copy it to the **top folder** of a USB stick or SD card (FAT32).

U3 Put the stick in the Cerbo and restart it (**Settings › General › Reboot**, or switch it off and on). The Cerbo unpacks the file and installs the driver while it starts, in Automatic.

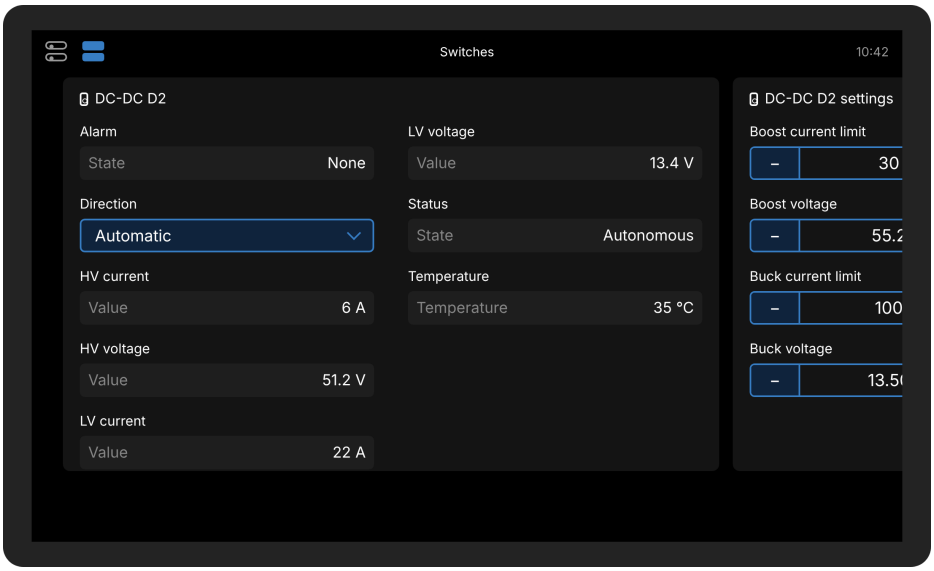
U4 **After about 2 minutes, take the stick out.** While it stays in, every restart unpacks it again and puts its settings back. Then open the switch pane: the DC-DC D2 cards should be there.

> Without SSH you can't run "find the converter" (5c). If the Status card says **No communication**, check the CAN port you chose in 3c, its speed (250 / 500 kbit/s) and the wiring, change `interface` if needed, and repeat U1–U4.

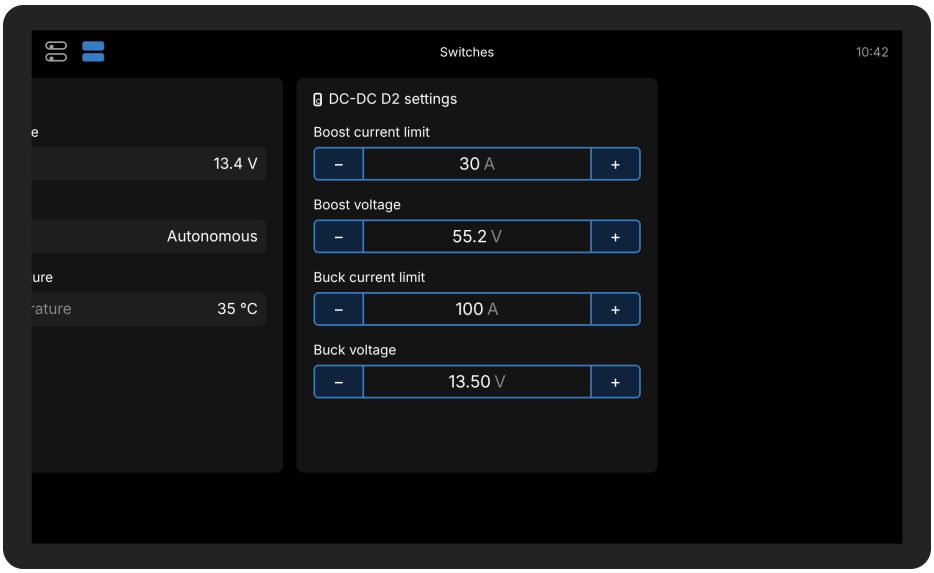
6 Use it

On the Cerbo screen (and Remote Console)

Tap the **switches icon** at the top left of the screen. Two cards appear. Swipe left to see the second one.



DC-DC D2: live readings, the alarm and status, and the Direction dropdown.



DC-DC D2 settings: tap − / + to change a value. It's used whenever the Cerbo is in control (Buck or Boost).

Direction: who's in charge

Choice	What happens
Automatic (default)	The D2 decides by itself, as it always has. It bucks (charges the 12 V side from 48 V) when the 12 V side drops below 12.5 V, as long as the 48 V side is 41–58 V. It boosts (pushes 12 V energy up to 48 V) when the 12 V side is 13.5–16 V, until it falls below 12.3 V. Between 12.5 and 13.5 V it waits in Standby. The Cerbo sends nothing.
Buck 48V to 12V	The Cerbo makes the D2 charge the 12 V side, at **Buck voltage** (13.5 V) and up to **Buck current limit**. In Automatic the D2 uses its own factory target (about 13.4 V) instead.
Boost 12V to 48V	The Cerbo makes the D2 push energy to the 48 V side, at **Boost voltage** and up to **Boost current limit**.
Off	The Cerbo tells the D2 not to convert.

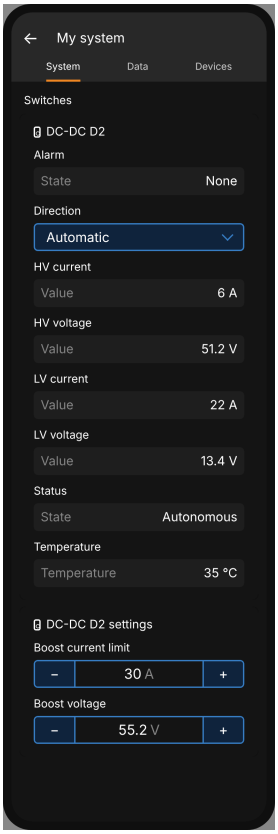
Changing between Buck and Boost always passes through Off for 1 second. Choosing Automatic again hands control back to the D2. The **Alarm** tile shows the most serious active alarm (red Fault label on a fault), and **Status** shows what the D2 reports it's doing, or **No communication**. The precharge controls are hidden because the D2 manual doesn't use precharge. To show them, or to rename or hide any item, go to **Settings › Devices › DC-DC D2**.

> **Limiting current to protect fuses and cables.** Buck or Boost with a lower current limit can keep the D2 below what a fuse or cable can take, but only while the Cerbo keeps sending its command every 10 ms. When the commands stop (the Cerbo restarts or updates, the driver stops, or the CAN cable comes loose), it isn't yet known what the D2 does; it may go back to full current (up to 178 A into the 12 V side). So never fit a bigger fuse than the cable is rated for, size fuses and cables for the D2's maximum or ask Nomadic to lower its own limit, and only rely on the Cerbo's limit after the hand-back test below. The project README explains the settings.

In the VRM app and portal

The same cards appear in the **Switches** widget in the VRM app, and in the **Switches** panel on the VRM portal dashboard. The Cerbo must be online with VRM. To change values from VRM, do step 3e (VRM Portal access level: Full).

The picture is an illustration. VRM draws its own version of these cards, so the layout may differ a little.



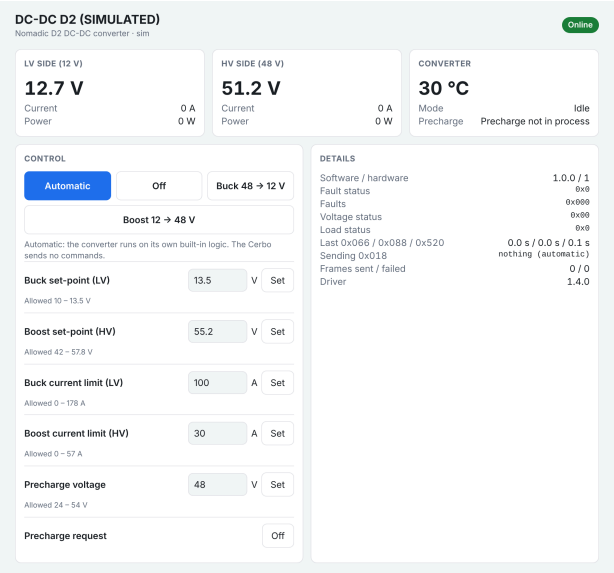
VRM app, Switches widget (illustration)

On a web page

On any phone, tablet or computer on the same network, open:

http://<Cerbo IP>:8088

This page shows everything, including the raw status bits and the exact command being sent. Set a password for it (`password =` in step 5d). Without one, **anyone on your network can operate the converter**.



The web page.

Test the hand-back before relying on Off, Buck or Boost

The Safe Test Plan (`docs/safe-test-plan.pdf`) has the full careful version. In short: it isn't known yet whether the D2 goes back to its own logic when the Cerbo stops sending commands, or keeps following the last command. Do this test once, with the 48 V side between 41 and 58 V:

T1 Choose **Buck**. Status should change to **Buck 48V to 12V**.

T2 Choose **Automatic**. Within a few seconds Status should show what the D2 does on its own: **Autonomous**, **Standby** (12 V side 12.5–13.5 V), **Buck** (below 12.5 V) or **Boost** (13.5–16 V).

T3 Choose **Buck** again, then unplug the CAN cable at the Cerbo. With a meter on the D2's 12 V terminals, watch whether the D2 keeps regulating to 13.5 V, stops, or goes back to its own logic (about 13.4 V). Plug the cable back in.

> If the D2 seems stuck on the last command (for example it stays in Standby in Automatic while the 12 V side is below 12.5 V), restart its controller by opening the fuses or breakers on **both** LV+ and HV+ (it has no KL15), wait a few seconds, close them, and tell Nomadic what you saw. Until you know how it behaves, leave the Cerbo in Automatic.

? Troubleshooting

What you see	What to do
Option 2: "not heard on any port"	Check, in this order: (1) the D2 has power: its LV+ terminal (9–16 V) or HV+ terminal (41–58 V), measured to GND. With neither, its controller is off and silent; (2) the CAN speed: if it reports bus errors, switch to the other speed (step 3c); (3) the wires (2b), and that CAN_H/CAN_L are in pins 1/2 of the D2 plug; (4) the termination reads about 60 Ω (2h); (5) the cable is in the Cerbo port you set up.
"ssh" or "tar" is not recognized	Install the Windows OpenSSH client: Settings › Apps › Optional features › Add a feature › OpenSSH Client.
"Connection timed out" or "Connection refused"	Check the IP address (menu option 6), that the PC and Cerbo are on the same network, and that Enable SSH on LAN is on (step 3d).
"Permission denied"	Wrong root password. Set it again (step 3d, item 3).
"REMOTE HOST IDENTIFICATION HAS CHANGED"	This happens after the Cerbo is reset or replaced. Use menu option 7, then try again.
Option 2: Venus OS version warning	Update the Cerbo (step 3a). Older firmware can't show the cards.
Nothing appears in the switch pane	Check the firmware is v3.80 or newer. Use option 5 (log) and look for "Registered ... on D-Bus". Make sure `switch_pane = yes` in config.ini.
Status shows Standby in Automatic	Normal when the 12 V side is between 12.5 and 13.5 V: the D2 has nothing to do.
Buck doesn't start	The D2 only bucks with the 48 V side between 41 and 58 V (D2 manual), even when the Cerbo asks.
Status shows No communication	The Cerbo can't hear the D2. Check that its LV+ or HV+ terminal is live, the cable and the termination.
The log says "CAN send failed"	Only happens when the Cerbo is in control (Off/Buck/Boost). Nothing on the bus is acknowledging: same checks as above. The speed is the usual cause.
A number won't go higher or lower	It has reached a limit from config.ini. To change the limit: option 1, edit, save, then option 4.
VRM shows the cards but won't accept changes	Set VRM Portal access level to Full (step 3e). The Cerbo must be online.
The "DC system" figure on the Cerbo looks wrong	The Cerbo counts the D2 as a DC-DC charger. Set `service_class = nomadicdcdc` in config.ini (option 1, then 4). The D2 leaves the Devices list, but the cards, VRM and web page keep working.

To change settings later, open Cerbo Setup, choose 1 to edit config.ini, save, then choose 4. The driver restarts with the new settings. Values you change on the screen, in VRM or on the web page are

remembered automatically. **To remove it,** choose 8 and type YES. The D2 carries on in its own automatic mode.

> Before you rely on Buck, Boost or Off, do the hand-back test in Step 6. While it's in control the Cerbo sends a command every 10 ms. If the Cerbo restarts or the cable comes loose, those commands stop, and it isn't yet known whether the D2 then goes back to its own logic.

Points to confirm with Nomadic

- What the D2 does when CAN commands stop: does it go back to its own logic, and after how long? (Your hand-back test will show this too)
- Whether it sends its status even when it isn't receiving commands (the driver assumes it does)
- Reprogramming the factory buck target to 13.5 V, if you want 13.5 V in Automatic as well
- Which direction counts as positive current in the readings